The Dhāraṇī That Pacifies the Disease of Smallpox

Toh 1019 · Derge Kangyur

The Dhāraṇī That Pacifies the Disease of Smallpox is a very brief incantatory text whose title is known here in English. Its Sanskrit and Tibetan titles cannot be determined with confidence from the source at hand. After a simple homage to the Three Jewels, it consists almost entirely of a single dhāraṇī, a Sanskrit spell addressed to the Blessed Mañjuśrī in his youthful form. The spell invokes the power and knowledge of all the tathāgatas and calls for protection on behalf of all beings, and its stated purpose is to pacify smallpox, which places it among the many Buddhist protective formulas used for healing and averting illness. It is Toh 1019 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the collection of dhāraṇī texts gathered alongside the tantra section of the canon.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

he bhagavāna mañjuśrī kumāra sarba tathāgata bala bidhijña sarba tathāgatānāṃ nāgaisti tiṣṭha sarba satvānāṃ svāhā

The dhāraṇī that pacifies the disease of smallpox is complete.

Translator's Notes

• The disease named in the title can mean smallpox or, more broadly, any pustular or blistering eruption of the skin. "Smallpox" is the usual rendering.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.